



Children's burden

Orphans eat at the Bamboo Shoot Orphanage in Ho Chi Minh City, in April 1980. Many of the orphaned children in Vietnam had American fathers, or birth defects as a result of chemical defoliants like Agent Orange.

» AFTER

A sizable Vietnamese refugee community (Viet Kieu) resides in the US, especially in California.

A BETTER LIFE

Vietnamese people in America have achieved **notable distinctions**, for example, as scholars and professionals, high-ranking military officers, and, in one case, as an NFL professional football player. Many first- and second-generation Viet Kieu have acquired wealth and return to Vietnam for business ventures.

Economic renovation (*dao moi*) in 1986 created a market system to help Vietnam's integration into the world economy. Since 2000, its growth rate has been among the highest in the world.